

RESOURCE 08 · INTERVIEW

The Tell Me About Yourself Pitch

A 90-second pitch with five beats beats a five-minute biography every single time.

A 90-SECOND ANSWER, FIVE BEATS

0s 15s 30s 50s 75s 90s



PROFESSION + LEVEL

"I'm a senior data engineer with eight years of experience."

~15 seconds

AREAS OF FOCUS

"Data infra for fintech and healthcare. AWS, Python, Spark."

~15 seconds

WHAT MAKES YOU DIFFERENT

"Started in backend eng, so I think about data systems like production services."

~20 seconds

ONE RECENT ACCOMPLISHMENT

"Led the migration from Redshift to Snowflake, cutting weekly compute spend by 40% and enabling real-time use cases we couldn't support before."

~25 seconds (concrete, quantified)

This is the part the interviewer pulls on next.

LOOKING FOR NEXT

"A senior or staff role where data is closer to the product."

~15s · optional

Anti-patterns to avoid

- ✗ **The biography.** Don't start with where you grew up or went to school.
- ✗ **The recap.** Don't list every job in order. The resume already does that.
- ✗ **The mission statement.** "Passionate about leveraging tech" means nothing.
- ✗ **The hedge.** Don't apologize for gaps or transitions up front. Reads as unsure.
- ✓ **Memorize two versions:** a 60-second cut for recruiters, 90 seconds for interviews. Practice out loud.